

Martin Abel

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APPOINTMENTS

Peter M. Small Associate Professor of Economics, Bowdoin College, 2026–present

Assistant Professor of Economics, Bowdoin College, 2022 – 2026

Assistant Professor of Economics, Middlebury College, 2017 – 2022

Research Fellow, Institute for the Study of Labor (IZA), 2019 – present

Affiliate, Abdul Latif Jameel Poverty Action Lab (J-PAL), 2020 – present

EDUCATION

Ph.D., Harvard University, Public Policy

MPA, Harvard University, International Development

Diplom, University of Jena, Economics

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

“The Effect of Reminders for Self-Set Goals on Productivity.” with T.Harigaya, M.Kremer, J.Zhu;
Journal of Development Economics (accepted).

“Name-Based Race Discrimination: The Role of Heuristics” with R.Burger;
Review of Economics and Statistics (forthcoming).

“Choice Over Payment Schemes and Worker Effort” with R. Burger;
Experimental Economics (accepted).

“Political Discrimination in Hiring” with A.Robbett and D.Stone;
Journal of Human Resources (forthcoming).

“The Effect of Information from Black Health Care Professionals on COVID Vaccination Take-up”
with T.Byker and J.Carpenter;
Health Economics 34.11 (2025): 2072-2096.

“Are Women Blamed More for Incorrect Financial Advice?” with E. Bomfim, I. Cisneros, J. Coyle, S. Eraou, M. Gebeyehu, G. Hernandez, J. Juantorena, L. Kaplan, D. Marquez, J. Mullen, P. Mulhern, A. Opong-Nyantekyi, R. Osathanugrah, J. Paul, A. Philie, L. Tingley, J. Wang;
Journal of Economic Behavior and Organization, 228 (2025), 106781.

“The Effect of Manager Gender and Performance Feedback: Experimental Evidence from India” with D.Buchman ‘21;
Economic Development and Cultural Change, 73.1 (2024), 307-338.

“Do Workers Discriminate Against Female Bosses?”;
Journal of Human Resources, 59.2 (2024), 470-501.

“Labor Market Discrimination and Sorting: Evidence from South Africa”;
Journal of African Economies, 32.4 (2023), 331-351.

“Pro-social Behavior in the Time of COVID-19: The Effect of Private and Public Role Models” with W.Brown;

Journal of Behavioral and Experimental Economics, 101 (2022): 101942.

“Socially Optimal Mistakes? Debiasing COVID-19 Mortality Risk Perceptions and Prosocial Behavior” with T.Byker and J.Carpenter;

Journal of Economic Behavior and Organization, 183 (2021): 456-480.

“Changing Gambling Behavior through Experiential Learning” with S.Cole, B.Zia.;

World Bank Economic Review, 35.3 (2021), 745-763.

“The Value of Reference Letters: Experimental Evidence from South Africa” with R.Burger, P.Piraino;

American Economic Journal: Applied Economics, 12.3 (2020): 40-71.

“Long-run Effects of Forced Resettlement: Evidence from Apartheid South Africa”;

Journal of Economic History, 79.4 (2020): 915-953.

“Bridging the Intention-Behavior Gap: Increasing Job Search and Employment through Action Planning” with R.Burger, E.Carranza, P.Piraino;

American Economic Journal: Applied Economics, 11.2 (2019): 284-301.

“Unintended Labor Supply Effects of Cash Transfer Programs: Evidence from South Africa’s Old Age Pension”;

Journal of African Economies, 28.5 (2019): 558-581.

WORKING PAPERS

“Can Temporary Wage Incentives Increase Formal Employment? Experimental Evidence from Mexico” with E.Carranza, K.Geronmio, M.E.Ortega;

Revisions Requested, American Economic Journal: Applied Economics

“AI Bias for Creative Writing: Subjective Assessments vs. Willingness to Pay” with R.Johnson;
Under Review

“Algorithm Aversion in Prosocial Tasks: Evidence from AI-Based Performance Evaluation” with R.Dawi, T.Lenk, A.Singer;

Under Review

“The Price of Unpredictability: Scheduling Demands, Gender and Selection in the Gig Economy” with P.Piraino, N.Jha *Under Review*

“Grade Inflation and the Interpretation of Labor Market Signals” with J.Carpenter, Z.Pu;
Under Review

OTHER PUBLICATIONS

“Youth Employment in South Africa” (2014) with M.Blair, R.Fabregas, K.Gumede, M.Leibbrandt ;
in *Youth and Employment in Sub-Saharan Africa: Working but Poor*; Routledge.

“China’s Development Policy in Africa” (2008) with G.Pehnelt; SA Institute for International Affairs.

REFEREING

American Economic Journal: Applied Economics, American Economic Journal: Economic Policy, American Economic Review, American Economic Review: Insights, American Law and Economics Review, Economic Development and Cultural Change, Economic Inquiry, Economic Journal, European Economic Review, Experimental Economics, Health Economics, International Journal of Manpower, Journal of Development Economics, Journal of Economic History, Journal of Economic Behavior and Organizations, Journal of European Economic Association, Journal of Behavioral and Experimental Economics, Journal of Economic Psychology, Journal of Human Resources, Journal of Political Economy, Journal of Political Economy: Microeconomics, Journal of Public Economics, Journal of the Economic Science Association, Labour Economics, Management Science, Oxford Bulletin of Economics and Statistics, Quarterly Journal of Economics, Review of Development Economics, Review of Economics and Statistics, Review of Economic Studies, World Bank Economic Review, World Development, World Development Perspectives, Economic History of Developing Regions, BMC Public Health Health Psychology and Behavioral Medicine, PLOS One, Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences

RESEARCH GRANTS

2025: AI vs. Human Monitoring (Bowdoin)
2024: Research on Unemployment (Amazon)
2022: Grant for Innovation in Diversity and Inclusion (AEA), w. J.Berazneva
2021 - 2022: Harvard University Morocco Employment Lab, with A.John
2019 - 2020: World Bank Gender Innovation Lab
2016 - 2019: Saudi Arabia Labor Market Research Fund, with R.Hanna and R.Pande
2015 - 2017: Gender Innovation Lab, with R.Burger and P.Piraino
2014 - 2017: Programme to Support Pro-poor Policy (South Africa), joint with R.Burger and P.Piraino

PRESENTATIONS

2026: Oberlin College, LACPAL, Colby College (LACBEE)
2025: Bowdoin (MEC), LAC-PAL, Amazon, GIGA (Hamburg), Hamburg U, Goettingen U, WZB Berlin, ESMT Berlin, Jena U, IWH Halle
2024: Colby College (MEC), LAC-PAL
2023: ILO (RDW), Wellesley College, Middlebury College, Amherst College (LACDEV)
2022: Bowdoin College, IFPRI, LACDEV, Amherst College, U Chicago (DIL), Yale U (NEUDC), Colby College, LACEA
2021: John Hopkins U, Williams College, Bristol U, Kiel U, U Cape Town, Boston U (NEUDC)
2020: Rotterdam U., SOLE, Dartmouth College (NEUDC), LACVDEV, World Bank, Harvard U (MEL)
2019: Harvard Kennedy School (EPOD), U Mass Amherst, World Bank Empirical Management Conference, Colby College (LACDEV)
2018: U Vermont, U Mass Amherst (NEEW), U Zurich, Williams College
2017: World Bank, Tufts U (NEUDC), Middlebury College, Stockholm School of Economics, Bates College
2016: MIT (NEUDC), Bowdoin College, U Mass Amherst (NEEW), Vassar College (LACDEV)
2015: Brown U (NEUDC), UC San Diego (PacDev), U Cape Town, Stellenbosch U
2014: Boston U (NEUDC), Yale U, Oxford (CSAE)

TEACHING

Artificial Intelligence and Economics, Bowdoin College (2024-2026)
Detecting Discrimination, Bowdoin College (2023)
Labor Economics, Bowdoin College (2022-2026)
Microeconomics, Bowdoin College (2022-2026)
Senior Thesis Workshop, Middlebury College (2020)
Microeconomic Theory, Middlebury College (2017-2020)
Economics of Discrimination, Middlebury College (2017-2020)
Economic Development Policy Design (2016), Harvard University (TF)
Econometrics (2011), University of Cape Town
Introductory Economics (2009), Harvard University (TF), *Distinction in Teaching Award*

OTHER PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Research Manager, J-PAL Africa, Cape Town, South Africa, 2010-2012
Consultant, UNICEF, Jaipur, India, 2009
Visiting Scholar, Institute for the World Economy, Kiel Germany, 2007

Date: September 13, 2026